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Virginia Board of Education, Special Committee on Standards of Accreditation, Wednesday, June 17, 2020

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HCYMQXsoLYs
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:40] uh emily webb yes so i was having i thought i was okay on my audio before okay and you all were having a little difficulty hearing me is the volume okay right now yes the volume is okay right now okay thank you thank you and dr pexton there you are hey how are you good i'm good i am uh still waiting on the doctor oh no uh yeah so i've talked to dan and he and if uh if i'm not

[00:01:19] able to kick this off uh he'll he'll kick it off for me and then i'll just get back on okay okay so is jen going to be the staff person doing all this we uh we have a joint crew here um that is going to be doing the presentation um it's going to mainly be jen as well as julie malik our director of accountability um and shelly loving rider who i think is going to kick things off for the presentation um once we get started and i will note that we are live on youtube

[00:01:58] so dr pexton it's yours all right are we ready we're ready to go all right um so i will be uh leading the uh i'm sorry i think a couple of folks will team we've got tammy okay yeah we have a quorum so we are ready to go okay can you hear me okay yes can you hear me okay yes yes okay sorry um so i'll be leading the committee that will be doing a review of our accreditation

[00:02:36] criteria and so what i'd like to do is just first kind of lay out what the scope of the committee's focus will be and then I will share who our board members are that will be participating in the review and

what I was hoping to accomplish today in this presentation was to allow the department to present to us just a good understanding of not only the baseline criteria of the accreditations just to make sure we're all at speed but also from more of a I will I don't

[00:03:12] I don't want to say a historical standpoint, but from a development standpoint, kind of what were some of the indicators or driving factors or intended outcomes that drove the criteria as the accreditation is established today. So we'll be looking to unpack a little bit of the why behind where we are today. And ultimately, the goal will be to evaluate the outcomes that we're seeing today as a result of the accreditation criteria, whether they're good outcomes or

[00:03:46] not good outcomes, negative outcomes, we want to identify if there's any room to address some of those negative outcomes. And if so, if we have some proposals on how we might do that, this committee would share those proposals. We recognize that we're probably at an opportune time to do this review considering everything we have going on um and so with the you know schools going through the changes that they're going through and the accreditation uh uh waivers that we will likely

[00:04:20] be considering at least for this upcoming year uh once we get back to our new normal whatever that is which will likely take some time over the next school year to do it'll be timely then for this committee to have any recommendations for, you know, any changes. I do want to say that from my perspective, the intent is not to go into this review looking to change criteria. It's to really validate the outcomes that the current criteria are creating. If those outcomes were expected

[00:04:53] or anticipated based on how the criteria was set, and if they weren't, then to have a healthy discussion about why we're getting the outcomes we're getting and what we might want to consider in the future. So that's the initial scope. I've asked Dr. Duran and Dr. Wilson and soon-to-be Dr. Vaught-Davis to join the committee with me. And so they will be our initial members. I am

[00:05:28] open if there's other board members that are just dying to be a part of this body of work. Of course, we're open for more participation. I wanted the board to get this overview as a group, though, so that once we finish this presentation and this meeting, I really want to open the dialogue with the board members just to make sure that the committee has a good breadth of input from the board as far as the things we want to make sure we go look at.

[00:06:00] And I also want to understand what kind of questions does the accreditation criteria leave the board with because that would inform some of our work as well so with that unless Dan would like to add any more context to the scope I will turn it back over to the department for the presentation I appreciate it just let me say this two things number one is this committee is an outgrowth of sort of item three of the comprehensive work plan we dealt with items one and two you know equity and teaching building leadership previously we have some more

[00:06:36] work to do there. But the third item was to look at what accreditation did, you know, both good and bad. We also recognize that the work done by Diane and her committee, you know, committee of the board to revamp the accreditation system has not had a chance to do anything yet. And so we're looking in part at, you know, components of a system that was in place for a long time. And in part, we're going to look at components of the new system to get some idea where we think it's going to go but in no way do we believe that uh you know people ought to understand that there were

[00:07:15] substantial changes to the system a year ago from the committee led by diane that's it right good afternoon uh look i'm trying to get uh miss holton on um but let me go ahead and uh i will share the screen for this presentation and then shelly i'll turn it over to you thank you emily i'll do

[00:07:54] a sound check first can you all hear me okay yes okay all right so um this afternoon we are going to provide you with uh an overview of the standards for accreditation and we do have a powerpoint if it's possible to pull that up. And it's important as you all begin your work on looking at the SOA for you all to have a clear understanding of what it does currently. And so as Emily mentioned this

[00:08:29] afternoon, Jen Pavarena, who is our current director of research, and Julie Molique, who is our director of accountability, will be doing most of this presentation. But I wanted to start it off with a little bit of an overview and perhaps some historical context. While Jen is the director of research, for those of you who've been on the board for a while, you will remember that she really served as the team lead as we revised the accreditation system for the 2017 SOA.

[00:09:06] And she was the person who brought many of the indicators and the discussions before the board. so jen is going to do much of the beginning of this presentation to provide you with some history and then prior to october of this past year we did not have a person in charge of accountability and so that's why jen was lucky enough to end up with that role we were fortunate to be able to add a position this last october and julie molique uh joined us she's our director of accountability

[00:09:45] and so she will uh go over the indicators uh with you uh the idea is that this is supposed to be a tag team presentation so if the person is presenting um you know needs uh a lifeline um the rest of us will certainly help um we also know there's a great deal of information here um and so we have provided uh time for you to ask questions after each major section but we would also encourage you to ask questions in between if something isn't clear

[00:10:25] the accreditation system is very robust but it has a lot of detail in it and so we know that it can be confusing and it's also particularly difficult to do this kind of presentation in a virtual environment. So we do encourage you to interrupt us if something isn't clear.

[00:10:46] So this is the overview of the presentation. I'm going to give you a bit of history. Jen is going to review the philosophy and the criteria used to select the indicators. And then Julie will look at various indicators, how the benchmarks were selected, and then talk about how the indicators and the benchmarks are combined to determine the accreditation status.

[00:11:12] So first, just a little bit of history. As Mr. Gecker mentioned, our current accreditation system has been in place for a very long time, but it may be important for you all to know that we did have another accreditation system prior to that one and it really was based on an input model so that we accredited schools based on class schedules staffing standards sometimes even the number of books in the library so school accreditation was really determined by a team

[00:11:51] of doe staff who went into the schools and reviewed the school to determine whether or not that school met the minimum standards in the mid 90s that was when we really began the the standards of learning reform in 1994 the national assessment of educational progress grade four reading scores from virginia dropped before the nation below the nation for the first time typically virginia has always scored very well on national assessments but for the first time virginia's grade four

[00:12:31] reading scores were actually below the nation that did set off a series of alarms and it precipitated a reform that included a revision to the standards of learning so the content standards themselves and then also an accountability model where we would have standards of learning tests measuring those standards and really a movement towards an accreditation system that would be based not only on the input standards but also on looking at student achievement and i'm going to take just

[00:13:07] a minute to read the foreword to the 1997 revision to the soa just to give you a flavor of where the board was at that time for the first time in virginia schools will earn their accreditation based on students achievement especially developed tests as well as on course offerings and staffing patterns standards of accreditation place emphasis on raising achievement standards for students increasing the requirements for graduation increasing the instructional time linking statewide accountability to test to uh virginia's nationally recognized standards of learning

[00:13:45] and establishing a school report card for parents and for the school community so at the time this was seen as very much a reform moving away from looking at just the inputs to a school and really what the school was producing and it was an attempt to better meet the request of the community and then if we could have the next slide this and so the system that was based on our standards of learning and graduation requirements as you all know was

[00:14:24] really in place for for about 20 years and then this last revision uh the revision began in 2016 and jen will talk about the timeline in a minute um over the years that this accreditation system was in place there was concern that it was based so much on standardized tests and that it didn't didn't really give a comprehension comprehensive picture of school quality so much like the 1997 revision where there was concern that what we had in place really didn't address the quality of the

[00:14:59] school. The concern in the 2016 time period was that we needed to have a system of accreditation that better reflected the quality of the school and was more appropriately focused on supporting school and moving towards a more focus on continuous school improvement. So that's a little history and i'll turn it to jen now to begin to talk about the timeline great thank you shelley um so the next two slides briefly highlight significant milestones for the most recent revisions

[00:15:39] for the soa and those began in earnest in july 2016 and were fully implemented for all schools this year during the 2019 2020 school year we had a phased implementation that i'll talk about in 2018 and 19. The order of the rest of the presentation is really also aligned with these milestones. We began in July 2016 with conversations with the board on just understanding the accountability framework and the board's philosophy to guide those revisions. So really sort of

[00:16:14] strategic overarching conversations about goals and strategies that we would take for revisions to the standards of accountability. And we debated questions as to the purpose and the value of accountability, how the general tenants and how the system should be organized. Then we moved into identifying indicators of highest priority. So as you can imagine we started with a pretty long list of indicators that we were interested in including in accountability and then whittled it down to indicators that met agreed upon criteria and i will go into a little bit more detail on that

[00:16:53] the doe staff then developed and reviewed with the board over several iterations calculations and benchmarks for each of those indicators we reviewed quite a bit of data during that process and we'll highlight that briefly then we discussed how all the indicators would work together to produce both a

single accreditation rating and to also trigger actions by the department to support schools and divisions. Next slide. So between when the board accepted the revised SOA in the proposed

[00:17:27] stage in June 2017 to when we first released accreditation ratings for schools in fall 2018, the board conducted a series of public hearings around the state and created multiple other opportunities for public comment and targeted feedback. In addition, DOE staff released to school divisions reports that modeled the new accreditation process based on historic data so these reports were instrumental for school divisions to understand the process of accreditation prepare both their staff and the public for its implementation and also provide some important

[00:18:07] feedback to the department and to the board on some of the business rules and indicator calculations that we had settled on in the fall of 2018 we accredited schools based on either the new accountability system or the previous accountability system so we considered that a transition year and then at the beginning of this school year in fall 2019 this was the first time that all schools were provided accreditation ratings using the new system next slide so the

[00:18:43] The next couple of slides reflect what the board agreed would serve as the foundation for accountability and the framework for revisions to the standards of accreditation in particular. We thought it would be important to revisit the why of the previous revisions as you consider the work of this committee.

[00:19:03] So what's on the slide here are the guiding principles or tenets of accountability the board agreed upon at the very beginning of our revision process. Virginia, the board agreed that our accountability system should provide a comprehensive picture of school quality, meaning it should include multiple measures.

[00:19:21] It should drive continuous improvement by focusing on achievement for all students, should build on the strengths and address gaps in the current system, which recognizes that we've learned some things from our experiences with the current and previous versions of accountability systems.

[00:19:40] And importantly, it would provide a system that informs technical assistance and drive school improvement resources. So more focus on taking a targeted approach versus a one size fits all. Next slide.

[00:19:56] So the board also agreed on the mechanisms of accountability, discuss these in detail, which reflects the ways in which the expectations for accountability are communicated. So just prior to the recent round of SOA revisions, the board discussed at length, redesign of the school quality profiles which as you know is the primary one of the primary ways in which our education stakeholders typically access information about schools. We then went through a strategic process of focusing on state accreditation obviously the bubble in orange

[00:20:31] and interspersed that conversation with information about what was to become the new federal education law as guidance became available and as the Virginia state plan was developed since the revisions to the SOA as you know the board then turned their attention to the SOQ which reflects the essential elements of schools and are designed to ensure the necessary resources are in place so in the past five years the board has made significant revisions and spent a considerable amount of time discussing each of the bubbles on this slide next slide so the board also agreed at

[00:21:11] the time on two characteristics of accreditation models they really wanted implemented in Virginia. This was based primarily on a review of the available types of accountability models as well as

Virginia's history with accountability and some other review of other states proposed plans. The board indicated a strong interest early on in the process to focus on multiple indicators of school performance and a matrix-based system so in contrast accountability systems that

[00:21:44] provide one value to a school like an a through f or a zero uh through a hundred uh might be a contrast to a matrix model and the major criticism of those uh rating models or index models is that the single value or a single letter doesn't capture enough information about how the school is performing what they're doing well on what they're not doing so well on and so models with multiple performance metal uh levels excuse me uh and matrix models do prioritize continuous improvement because you are always striving for that next performance level so the board likes the idea of

[00:22:23] having a more comprehensive picture of how the school was performing instead of a single indicator or a single roll-up of an indicator and also thinking about continuous improvement next slide okay so the the quality of the accreditation model was really based on the quality of the metrics selected so this slide shows the checklist that the board established to examine the quality of each indicator as they were selected for accreditation so i'll expand on just a few of of these that were really influential in our discussion

[00:23:02] about the final list of indicators. So for the second and third one down, standardized data collection and metrics that are valid and reliable, we had quite a bit of discussion about these. There were measures on our indicators on our long list of our sort of ideal list of indicators that we wanted included in accreditation that did not meet this criteria.

[00:23:25] So they either were not fully standardized across all school divisions or we didn't have a valid and reliable method of collecting the data. On the fourth down on the list, so the metric is modifiable through school level policies and practices.

[00:23:41] There was a lot of discussion around this as well, where if it's going to be part of an accreditation model and that accreditation model puts some accountability towards the schools, then we want to make sure that those items the accountability model are actually modifiable by the school or or the division so something within their control and then the six on the list list that the metric does not unfairly impact one type or group of schools or students we wanted to make sure that our metrics uniquely reflect school

[00:24:15] quality and add value when identifying struggling schools and are not just different lenses for looking at the same issue so we wanted to make sure that we didn't have a set of metrics that was only identifying schools that were in poverty for example because we we wanted a more comprehensive picture of how schools are doing next slide okay so these are the indicators that are currently in the accreditation model in just a moment i'm going to turn it over to to julie who's going to walk

[00:24:52] through each of these with you individually and talk about the calculations and the performance levels for these so i'm just going to briefly highlight them here and then you'll you'll see them again so in the achievement category we have five indicators an english academic indicator that includes the passing uh passing rates on reading and writing assessments as well as students who show growth in reading if they fail the assessment and english learner students who demonstrate progress that is what we refer to as the combined rate there is also a math academic indicator for

[00:25:29] all students that is a combined rate it is the pass rate on the state assessments plus students who do not pass but show growth we have an academic indicator for science and then we have an academic achievement gap indicator for english and math and those are calculated similar to the all students rate but applied to individual students or reporting groups next slide so these are the additional indicators that are currently in our accreditation model for schools with a graduating class we use the graduation and completion index that is a metric

[00:26:07] that we have you we used in previous accreditation models as well we also added in the dropout rate for schools with a graduating class all schools are evaluated on chronic absenteeism which is defined as students missing 10 or more of the school year and then we also do have a college career and civic readiness index which is phasing into the state accreditation and it includes metrics that examine completion of advanced coursework students who earn cte credentials

[00:26:40] and students who participate in work-based or service learning next slide so here you see the performance levels these are assigned to each of the indicators in the accreditation system the language on the slide here is exactly out of the soa so it will likely look familiar to you level one is considered at or above standard it also includes schools who have shown improvement from level two level two is what we call near standard and it show it also includes schools

[00:27:16] that have shown improvement from level three and then level three is below standard and also include schools that have had consistent performance at a level two or below for more than four consecutive years. And next slide. So I want to touch a little bit on the process we use to define the performance levels or the benchmarks for each of those performance levels for the indicators.

[00:27:49] We did consider quite a bit of both research and data during this process. So, this included reviewing scientific literature on the indicators and examining models from other states, as well as a deep dive into the patterns and trends in Virginia's data.

[00:28:08] We conducted several iterations of data modeling and presented that to the board, identifying possible cut points and seeing how schools were distributed around those cut points. And we also analyzed the relationship between those selected indicators and other drivers of school performance.

[00:28:25] and then the last slide for me here is just a summary of some of the important questions and discussions the board had when considering the benchmarks for each of these indicators so the board spent a lot of time discussing whether the goals and the benchmarks that for the indicators were realistic or aspirational whether they had considered or discussed unintended consequences or certainly hold for heard from stakeholders about potentially unintended consequences and then we also had a discussion about what does progress look like at the school

[00:29:01] level um and how do we know if we if we are moving in the right direction so those were big questions that we that we discussed throughout this process i think we have um a short break for questions i believe before we get to the next section yes so i'm happy to take any of those and then julie will um we'll pick this up with the indicators do we have hey go ahead yeah yeah this is uh this is

[00:29:39] keisha um i do have one question and i and i possibly could have missed it um but relative to the i think it was slide 14 where you identified uh all of the criteria that was considered in forming the indicators did you also already address um what specific audiences were included in in in providing you

know input into that meaning i i know we had like stakeholder sessions but i mean specific organizations um can you talk a little bit more about that sure um i think

[00:30:19] actually emily might be able to better um articulate uh the the stakeholder groups that participated in the public hearings in particular um emily i i'm sorry to put you on the spot but i don't know if you would sure that's no problem um so we in to be honest i came sort of partway through um the 2017 soa revisions um but before i came the summer before i came i know that the board had um a round of stakeholder engagement public hearings that were held during the summer

[00:30:56] And then throughout the year while we were going through each of the indicators and working through the philosophy, they had, you know, they engaged all of kind of the normal stakeholders that you would think of. Certainly the Superintendents Association, the School Board Association, the PTA, the Virginia Education Association, principals. We also often at our Wednesday meetings would have different panelists come in and speak to the board about the indicator,

[00:31:31] about the different experiences that they had. And then once we had kind of a path forward, and this is when I joined the DOE team, we did have a series of five public hearings that summer that we promoted to all of the associations as well as as to the public for them to engage in the work of the board i'm happy to to go back to my notes to to look a little bit more about all

[00:32:05] of the different groups that we engaged but we did travel around to five different locations and had a pretty good turnout at each one but i'm happy to to provide a little bit more detail at a a feature meeting as well. Yeah, that would be great if you have the notes. I really was asking, the public hearing experience was helpful to understand, but I also was hoping to understand if relative to this, I guess I'll call it the staff work, the actual staff work that was done,

[00:32:41] were there any more, you know, intimately involved organizations even prior to or in between public hearing sessions. Jen, can you talk, I cannot remember the name of the group that was helping us a little bit along the way. Yeah, we had ECS work on a couple different indicators and one other. Yeah, we did have, so we had sort of two areas of engagement. So one was sort of with the groups that typically support SEAs as they were working through this process.

[00:33:18] ecs education commission of the states was one of those we also reached out um to linda darling hammond we also had conversations with ccsso uh as well um the other so and so that was kind of reaching up i guess um into uh into some expertise uh in terms of reaching out i would say into um like the the school divisions in in virginia um in between the the board meetings uh the superintendent at the time superintendent staples would hold um conference calls for um school

[00:33:53] divisions and for um your like our sort of top five advocacy organizations so vast vea um the principals associations etc to go through um what we were uh planning to present at the board meeting and get some early feedback on that um so that process um generally occurred um uh just a couple of days or so before a board meeting so that was also an opportunity uh to engage at the department we had an internal uh working group uh that represented multiple groups obviously within

[00:34:29] the agency as well um i'm not sure if that was a little bit closer to answering your question dr Yes, that was that was very helpful. I do have two more questions, just kind of one along the same lines.

[00:34:44] Were there any organizations or any data captured from to compare our accreditation system to other states? So was there any, I guess, external state data considered?

[00:35:02] Yeah. So to the extent that information was available, we did look at other state models at the time that we were developing the standards of revising the standards of accreditation. I think every state was trying to figure out what they were going to do in response to the new federal education law.

[00:35:22] So there wasn't. So we had a lot of information on existing state systems, but not a lot of information on how states were revising those systems. those systems because everybody was working on it at the same time. There were a couple of states where that were sort of ahead of us, at least in terms of putting out public information about their systems.

[00:35:44] So we leaned heavily on California as one example. They were using a matrix model are leaning towards using a matrix model. And so they had a lot of public documentation that was available on that, not a state, but in Canada and Alberta.

[00:36:01] They also had a matrix model of accountability for their schools, so we gleaned some information from them as well. Education Commission of the states was particularly helpful in sort of culling through all of the information that states put out and putting together kind of comprehensive documents for where states were. So we were able to give the board a sense of like other, um like the number of states that were including certain measures in their accountability system so we could say for example at the time you know x number of states have a school climate measure

[00:36:38] x number of states have a college and career readiness measure um that was really i mean that was the sort of the job and the role of education commission of the states was to compile all of that information so we were able to review that at sort of a very high level for most states um and then for some states we were able to glean more information if they had things that were publicly available yeah and dr pexton we're happy to um i'm happy to kind of go through those presentations that we gave to the board while we were working through this process

[00:37:12] that talks more about what other states were doing and we can provide those to you and to the other committee members kind of in the in between for you all to review those yeah that would be extremely helpful um my last question is really just clarifying question for slide 15 the questions that were listed on slide 15 um did you present those to to imply that we would we would hear the how those questions got answered in this next presentation or um because ultimately those are a lot of the questions that you know this committee is going to be wanting to ask i'm

[00:37:48] curious of that what what the actual answers were so yeah are we going to hear that shortly um so actually i i think the point of including this was actually an old slide that we repurposed so the the the reason that i put it in the appropriate template i should say um i think the reason that i included it here is because these are the these are essentially the questions we asked of the board after um while we were making the decisions about the benchmarks um and so i i don't have sort of the detailed feedback on each of these for each of the benchmarks um but i'm sorry for each of the

[00:38:22] indicators um but i i think that you know in the conversation that the board had around developing the benchmarks these are kind of the themes that continue to come up so the decisions that resulted were a reflection of the conversations that they had around these topics and i think there are certainly as we move into julie's presentation about the indicators um if there's sort of context that i think of around the discussion on a on a particular decision i'll sort of chime in and add that but these were sort of the overarching questions that the board

[00:38:56] often considered when when developing the benchmarks for the indicators so if I may chime in madam chair the a couple of comments and a couple of questions I am remembering that one criteria we did not have originally and it shows in the outcome is simplicity and i just put that on the table it's a very complex system um i thought one

[00:39:32] of the criteria we did have on the table and maybe a criteria in the right word maybe principles was alignment with the federal system so that we wouldn't have to have a dual system the way we had previously and i didn't see that show up uh i also thought that there was something more explicit about student growth i do see the the references to continuous quality improvement but that's really kind of school focused and i thought we had a a a clear focus on on growth and so my that that would be a question is where did that fall out and and then the final one is back

[00:40:12] to observation i'm surprised but now remember seeing this that we didn't have an explicit focus on the equity impact of the accreditation model and it may be that uh president gecker's clear leadership that helped us get to a clear statement of uh of a five-year plan and a focus on our limited clear number of priorities and where we elevated equity uh happened after much of this work so uh maybe maybe we it didn't catch up with it but um and and obviously we were thinking about

[00:40:50] equity and a lot of things like the continuous quality improvement etc but i i i i'm not questioning the presentation but i'm in retrospect surprised that we didn't have a more explicit emphasis on equity so the one piece of all that that might be a question jen growth didn't didn't we have something more on growth and and oh and also the about aligning with the federal yeah yeah thanks miss holton so um so i'll address both of those. So in terms of alignment with ESSA, it's so an interesting historical perspective.

[00:41:25] In the very beginning of this, we were very much interested in aligning with ESSA and even used language to suggest that the two would be almost seamless or integrated. Unfortunately, when we came around to developing our state plan and having that plan approved, we started to become very we we had to become divergent in terms of what the feds would accept from us and what we wanted the state model to be and so um i'm gonna pause just for a moment and see if shelley wants to add any context to that that i didn't cover but but just before you do

[00:42:03] that to say it was still our principle we just weren't able to fully execute that yes correct that's correct miss colton so our attempt was to align them as much as possible and we did use the word alignment knowing that there were some things that we valued in virginia that we wouldn't be permitted to do when we submitted our first version of the essa plan it essentially reflected the accreditation model and it was rejected so what we have now is still loosely aligned

[00:42:38] but it is certainly not as aligned as we had hoped. For example, you know, we really value the combined rate in the accreditation system because, as you noted, it values growth. In our ESSA system, we were required to separate growth out. So yes, you are correct that it was an attempt to align without giving up in our state accreditation system what we really valued. And as far as your comments about growth that was certainly part of the philosophy and i think as we go through the

[00:43:13] indicators you'll see that we we definitely uh valued growth i think maybe that was intended to be captured by the comment about continuous improvement and i have a question miss holton just to just to follow up on the equity piece about the timing of this the board approved the final um stage of the

proposed regulations the same month that you approved your five-year comprehensive plan so while the board had been discussing equity through the several months before that

[00:43:48] as you were developing your comprehensive plan you know the the soa the crux of it had already been done so while it was a focus i think it maybe there wasn't as much of alignment as you all have been having um since you adopted the comprehensive plan in november of 2017.

[00:44:08] could i ask a question here just to put on the table for further consideration at another time on slide 10 i think it is um you identified jen the criteria that we ultimately used when selecting the indicators and particularly items two and three there i wonder if since we have adopted our indicators if there's been any progress in terms of standardized data collection across more school divisions than it was at that particular time and whether or not we have more reliable and valid data than we did again a couple years ago and if we think

[00:44:46] about the indicators that fell off the list because of those two things and they were high priorities for us originally if there's an opportunity for those you know for that conversation to have it so that's not a question to be answered necessarily right now but i would be interested in knowing more about that great we'll make a note of that and dr wilson i would say that there's definitely going to be some data that we collect now that was not available to you then uh and whether it's reliable and valid i'll leave to jen but there's certainly more indicators that you

[00:45:22] could consider um well with that i think i think that covers everyone's questions i don't see anybody raising their hand. And Julie, I'll go ahead and get you queued up. Okay, here we go. There we go.

[00:45:48] There I am. Thank you, Emily. Now that you have a comprehensive view of kind of the timeline and decisions and research and processes involved to determine indicators, I'm going to take you through kind of a deeper dive into each indicator. We'll look at the calculations and the benchmarks of each indicator and how that's used to roll up into the accreditation status um so let's begin by looking at the combined rate for english it's been mentioned a couple times already today each each indicator will have a slide similar to this i'm just going to kind of walk it

[00:46:24] walk you through it real quick the combined rate for english it's important to note that this indicator does give equal credit for students who pass the reading sol and writing assessments also gives equal credit for students who didn't pass but showed growth on the reading assessments in grades four through eight and it gives equal credit to english learners who did not pass the assessment or show appropriate growth but did show progress toward english language attainment through the access for else assessment so it's a multi-faceted indicator we'll take a look at what that actually looks like in just a minute but before we do that

[00:47:01] while we're on this slide, I'd like to focus on the level designations. Notice for most indicators, there's a couple paths to reach each level, which include improvement and, of course, the overall calculation. So if we look at level one here, we notice that we do look at the current year rate or a three-year combined rate. And then we compare that to the benchmark. For level one, for the combined rate for English that benchmark is 75 or if the school is is reaching kind of the

[00:47:37] range within level two they can also show an improvement on the failure rate of 10 in order to achieve the level one so that also shows school-wide growth and change and the failure rate also allows them to bump up to the next level so that's level one and and you'll see kind of that philosophy repeated

throughout the presentation we look at level two again we look at the current or three-year rate um the the span there is kind of in between the level one

[00:48:10] and level three marker and it also has the 10 improvement failure rate provision from the previous year but notice it's just 50 to 65 percent and then the level three is 65 or lower but also or the school could reach a level three if they're at level two or level three for four consecutive years as jen mentioned earlier next slide okay um this might look familiar to some of

[00:48:47] you but this is a kind of a depiction of what that looks like for the combined rate um so in in this school there are 10 students and that's assumed that six of them meet meet the pass rate passed the assessment. One student sees growth in the reading assessment, and one student didn't pass nor showed growth, but they did show progress toward English language attainment.

[00:49:16] So for this school, out of those 10 students, 8 would be considered part of the combined rate, and the combined rate for this school would be 80%. Again, through this depiction, you see that there is equal equal weight for these three categories notice the english learner progress is for english only and we're going to talk about the math combined rate in just a moment

[00:49:45] okay next slide okay so now let's look at the combined rate for mathematics this is an undisputed account students who either pass the mathematics assessment or students who show appropriate growth on the mathematics assessments at grades four through eight and through algebra one so in the In the previous slide, if we change the methodology to remove that EL progress piece, there would be seven students in the numerator and the same students in the denominator for a combined rate of 70.

[00:50:20] Again, if we look at the level of determinations, we see that it is either the current year or the three-year combined rate, whichever is higher, and we compare it to the benchmark of 70%. There is also a similar provision for a reduction in the failure rate of 10% from the previous year.

[00:50:43] two again has that gap between the level three benchmark and the level one and you could also show that decrease in failure rate in order to achieve a level two and the level three is again 65 percent or lower or if the school is a level two or level three for four more consecutive years next slide and the final subject level achievement i'm sorry can i ask a question this is dr peckson

[00:51:16] just just for my clarity um when it says three year combined rate is is that any different distinction from average rate am i am i understanding that differently it is it's actually the sum of the numerators over the three years over the sum of the denominators over the three years so we don't actually take the average of the percent we do a recalculation so there is the difference very good i just wanted to make thank you yes ma'am okay um the final subject is

[00:51:51] our science and the rate for science isn't a combined rate is that it is a strict pass rate which means only students who pass a science assessment are counted in this numerator there isn't a particular growth measure for science due to the fact the assessments are not administered in subsequent years back to back again the level one benchmark for science is your 70 and it also has the provision to bump up to level one if your percent lands you at level two but you had an improvement in the failure rate level two bridges the gap between level one and level three

[00:52:25] with the improvement rate provision and level three is again 65 or lower with the four consecutive years provision okay so those are your three academic indicators let's take a quick look at the

gaps and then we'll take another pause so next slide so there are two achievement gap indicators one for mathematics and one for english the purpose of these indicators was to take a closer look at the school's student groups who are not meeting state expectations for the different

[00:53:01] subjects and who therefore could benefit from direct supports the overall achievement gap indicator for a school is determined through a two-step process the first step is to assign a performance level your level one two or three for each student group represented in the school how do we do that well we actually take the data for each student group and we use the exact same calculation and benchmark method we just reviewed for english and mathematics so this allows us to determine a level one level two or level three for each student group within the school and then the second step is to evaluate how many groups are at each performance level

[00:53:41] to determine a school's overall achievement gap for that school and these are the student groups that we evaluate within the schools note multiple races is was new to be implemented in 2021 so it will be implemented at the next accreditation cycle okay next slide so when we evaluate the student group performance levels within the school this is like i said i'll show you this in just a minute but we look at all the student groups in the school and all the levels the student groups

[00:54:20] achieve if no more than one student group is a level two and everybody else is at level one then that school receives the level one for the overall achievement gap indicator to achieve a level two you have two or more student groups at level two but you can have two or more student level two groups at level two or no more than one student group at level three so you can have one level three, the rest ones and twos. Level three, you have two or more student groups achieving at level three, and your overall indicator is a level three. Now, if you'll notice, there is something

[00:54:59] missing in this table that was in the other tables, and that's that four consecutive year provision. That is still applied to this indicator, but it is actually applied at the student group level, and so a student group could have a level three due to four consecutive years at level two and three, But then that student group has the designation of level three, and then it's evaluated to determine the overall level for that school. So next slide. The only thing that changed here is the word English to mathematics. So it's very similar.

[00:55:40] Again, level one or all level ones with one level two, level two, all level ones and twos with no more than one level three, and level three is two or more student groups at level three. So let's take a moment and look at what that really looks like. So if we look at School A, School A has level one for all their student groups with a level two for English learners. Therefore, School A does achieve a level one for this indicator. If we look at School B, they have all level ones and two level twos, but they do have that one level three,

[00:56:16] which gives them a level two, but it is important to note that if the students with disabilities in school B were a level two, they would still achieve a level two because it's more than one student group at level two. And then if we look at school C, they have two student groups achieving at level three, therefore their overall gap indicator is level three.

[00:56:41] Okay, next slide. And I think we're going to take a moment to pause for questions about the academic achievement indicators, if there are any.

[00:57:03] Okay. Not seeing any hands raised. We may be good to know. Okay, great. Then we can move on to the other indicators. So we're going to address the other indicators that address school progress, student engagement, or college and career readiness. And those are indicators that Jen already gave you a preview for. But again, we're going to do a little bit of a deeper dive.

[00:57:30] The Graduation Completion Index, or the GCI, it's very important to first understand what students are included and considered in this calculation or what students are in the denominator. The basis for the calculation are students who entered ninth grade four years prior to the calculation year.

[00:57:48] In other words, the fourth year of their high school career. We remove those who transferred out of the school and we add those who transferred into the school. And students with disabilities and English learners are carried over to additional cohorts until they complete their educational career. So GCI is based on a variety of different student outcomes and whatever happens at the end of their four-year cohort.

[00:58:16] And each outcome is assigned a different value. And that value is used to determine the school's GCI. So let's take a look at that as an example so that we can walk through on what that looks like. Next slide, please. Okay, so if we consider under the calculation, there's the point value column. So if the student receives a diploma, any of the Virginia diplomas, then they receive 100 points towards the GCI.

[00:58:43] Each student earns 100 points. If they receive a GED, they earn 75 points towards the GCI. The Certificate of Completion earns 25 points. If a student is still in school continuing their education, they receive 70 points. dropouts will not receive any points. So the GCI is actually the average number of points earned by students within this cohort.

[00:59:08] So how do we determine that? Well, to determine this, we take the number of students at each outcome and we multiply by their point value. Then we add all these results together to get the total points earned at this school.

[00:59:24] earned 7155 points out of their students in the cohort. There were 80 students in the cohort. Therefore, when we divide, we take 7155 and divide by 80, and that gives us a GCI of 89.

[00:59:42] 89 is the value that we will use to compare to benchmarks to determine what level the school earns for the GCI. Julie, before you go on, could I ask a question? Of course. Maybe I missed it, but where do the point values come from?

[01:00:04] - I'm gonna defer to Jen or Shelly. Those were determined, I would assume during the, well, this is a historical measure. So this has been around a while. So this was actually available in the previous system as well.

[01:00:21] But I'll defer to them for any historical reference of where those point values came. - Julie, you are correct that this is an index we've used for quite some time. I believe that these values were established in board guidance some time ago, but we can verify that.

[01:00:40] Jen, do you have any additional information? - I think the only other information that I have is that they were based on some research by the director of research who was here previous to me, but I don't have much more history.

[01:00:56] We can certainly look into it. - Yeah, I'm just curious, you know, what message are we sending by the point values as they are identified? And I'm sure there is a reason, I just would like to understand

what it is.

[01:01:12] - Absolutely, that's understandable. - We can provide more information. - Okay, so next slide please. Okay, this looks familiar.

[01:01:27] So again, this indicator is only applied to schools with a graduating class. You're not gonna hold GCI to a school that ends in fifth grade. The level one benchmark is set at a GCI of 88 higher, but notice there is also an improvement provision.

[01:01:45] That's of a 2.5% improvement from the previous year, and I believe that 2.5% was determined through data analysis at the time the benchmarks were established, so it was part of that conversation. So it's not 10%, which would be, I think, a larger jump for a measure that's already sitting in the '80s.

[01:02:09] So it was determined to be 2.5 percent. Level two, again, bridges the gap, but it also has that ability for a level three school to go to level two if they show that 2.5 percent improvement.

[01:02:25] The level three is at 80 or lower, and it also has that same fourth and second year provision. Next slide, please.

[01:02:42] We mentioned dropout in the GCI, but dropout is actually its own indicator in the accreditation system once again we base the dropout calculations on the four-year on-time graduation cohorts with the same adjustments that i spoke of earlier for gci students are not considered dropouts if they achieve one of the outcomes listed on the slide at the end of their four-year cohort so if they receive a diploma certificate or ged if they transferred out of the state or to a private school if they unfortunately were deceased or if they were on a documented school approved long-term

[01:03:18] absence they do not count as a dropout if they're still enrolled in school in a Virginia school if they're in jail or juvenile detention facility or if they're enrolled in another state operated agency they're not considered a dropout so pretty much everyone else is a dropout another way to think of this is it's the percent of students who left the school permanently at any time during a four-year cohort, and we do or do not know the whereabouts if they stop their education or if we're just not sure where they ended up, they're considered a dropout.

[01:03:54] So let's look at an example of a dropout rate calculation. Can I ask a question real quick for clarification? I don't know why I'm having a hard time understanding the four-year cohort. I get the context on the four-year cohort, 9th through 12th grade, but then I guess relative to a calculation and you mentioned it earlier on slide 26 when you're talking about it includes students with disabilities and English learners carried over from previous cohorts. So I guess I'm trying to understand how the cohort model works within the math. Sure. Relative to the index.

[01:04:31] Would you talk a little bit more about that? Sure. So when students enter into ninth grade or whenever they enter into a Virginia school, they're placed in a cohort. The expectation is, okay if if i entered in i may have to count on my fingers i apologize if i entered in um 15 16 then 15 16 16 17 17 18 18 19 18 19 is my expected four-year cohort so at the end of that time we're going to evaluate that student as part of the denominator for these indicators they've had four

[01:05:10] years in high school so at that point we would expect them to graduate or that we would expect them to have some sort of high school outcome. Now, as far as the students with disabilities and student English learners, Virginia has a provision that if they're not quite there after four years, then we do

reevaluate them again in the fifth year to see if they've achieved an outcome, a desirable outcome, and then they can extend cohorts. They can go and they'll be in the next cohort as well if their education continues but for the large majority of students it's from the

[01:05:49] point they entered ninth grade and we determined that they've had four years of high school experience what happens at the end of that four-year experience we would expect them to graduate or or have some sort of outcome so it's the school's responsibility at that point and so that we look at all the students that um were expected to have an outcome at that point does that that help it's you're on mute keisha yeah sorry yeah uh yeah i think i think that helps

[01:06:26] but so is it realistic to think that an average high school is currently managing four general ed cohorts at a time um is is is that what feeds the calculation because you know you've got your ninth graders in a cohort your 10th graders your 11th and 12th so is that so i think that's an excellent way to think about it. And so there's actually four calculations that are done for each group, for each school that's built into this calculation. I see Diane shaking it down.

[01:07:02] It kind of rolls, but we don't actually pull those numbers until the end of that fourth year to do these calculations, because that's when we expect these outcomes to take place. So the schools do monitor all along the way, and we do give them data to kind of keep an eye on the students who are in each cohort to make sure they're on track to get where we need them to be so if a student drops out um and then drops back in do they drop back into a new cohort because they're now delayed right they'll they'll drop back in but it'll be the same cohort that they

[01:07:41] were in previously but they wouldn't for the for the purpose of accreditation uh that student would not be considered a quote unquote dropout if they were still in school at the end of that that four years so that we don't drop out that they had two or three years ago if they come back and continue their education for this instance um for this dropout calculation they're still not they wouldn't be considered a dropout if they were continuing their education at the end of that four year

[01:08:13] okay okay thank you it is it's hard to wrap your mind around how do i yes this is diane I just want to highlight one other thing. For children with disabilities, because the requirement enables us to educate them up to the age of 21, their cohort would necessarily, could necessarily be much longer. And so just adding that piece of information in as well.

[01:08:49] Thank you, Ms. Atkinson. Okay. So let's look at that calculation slide, please. Okay. So if we If we look at this school, and we have actually 78 students that have been in high school for four years.

[01:09:17] But if you look at the two in parentheses, essentially those are students with disabilities and English learners still in that school. So we take those two and we move them to the next cohort. So the denominator for the dropout rate is actually going to be 76.

[01:09:34] In this example, 64 of those students received a diploma, three received a GED, two received a certificate of completion, and two students are continuing their education even though they are not a student with a disability or an English learner.

[01:09:50] In that group is identified that five of them don't meet any of the criteria, so therefore they are considered dropouts. So the dropout example, you take the number of dropouts, which is five, and divide by the applicable cohort in this case is 76 students in the cohort which gives you a 6.58 dropout rate so

next slide so this is the first indicator where lower is better right so we want a lower dropout rate all the other indicators we wanted a higher indicator rate so again it's only

[01:10:29] applicable to schools with a graduating class and we do consider a current in a three-year Level one are schools with no more than 6% of students being assigned as dropouts, so 6% or lower. Notice we also have an improvement opportunity for dropout, and that's a 10% rate improvement if you are in the level two band, but yet you demonstrate a 10% improvement.

[01:10:56] Level two is greater than 6%, but no more than 9%, or you demonstrate the improvement. Level three is greater than 9% of the students are deemed dropouts, or there's also that four-year consecutive year provision. Okay, next slide please.

[01:11:18] So the next indicator we'll discuss is the student engagement indicator, chronic absenteeism. This indicator is a measure of what percent of students in a school are deemed chronically absent. A student is chronically absent if he or she is absent 10% of the days they are enrolled in the school. This includes excused and unexcused absences. However, it's important to note that provisions are in place to give allowances for students assigned in home-based and homebound instructional settings as well as students who are not in school for over half the year so it's

[01:11:56] students who are absent in the days they're enrolled in the school 10 of the time so for example the student who's enrolled for the entire year for 180 days to be considered chronically absent a student would be out approximately two days a month or just over three weeks in the year so let's look at an example so this is mark mark is um in membership only 160 days out of the 180

[01:12:27] school days mark missed 11 days so if we divide 11 by 160 we get 6.9 therefore mark is not considered chronically absent because it is less than 10 so he has missed 11 days but yet he is not considered chronically absent so in this example mark would have to miss 16 days or more to be considered chronically absent and counted in the school's chronically absent in the numerator of the calculation. Next slide please. So this is another indicator where lower is better.

[01:13:08] So what we do is we get a percent by calculating the total number of students considered chronically absent and dividing by the total number of eligible students in the school to derive at the percent of students chronically absent. This indicator does apply to all schools and the benchmarks are as you see on your screen no more than 15 percent there's a 10 improvement possibility so the school either has no more than 15 percent of students deemed chronically absent or they have improved their improvement from temper improved their rate by 10 percent over

[01:13:46] the previous year level two bridges the gap between 15 and 25 and it also has that improvement possibility in level three is greater than 25 percent of the students in the school are considered chronically absent um or the four consecutive year criteria next slide so finally and last but not least yes questions i'm sorry i do have a question about the level one no more than 15 why is that

[01:14:23] no more than 10 of the criteria of the indicator it says that this is based on the 10 measure um well it's a school could have 11 or 12 or 13 and still still meet this criteria be a level one correct it's it's a different percent so uh this 15 or the percent of students within the school

[01:14:52] that missed more than 10 of the year so the first step is okay thank you you bet thank you okay next slide okay so the college and career readiness indicator um this is a measure of opportunity schools

give their students in order to prepare them for to be college career and civically ready there's actually four strands of this indicator they are credit received for

[01:15:26] advanced coursework they are cte finishers with a cte credential they've completed a workplace learning experience or a service learning experience again this rate is based on the four-year cohort that we've talked about a couple times already today it's important to note that students can earn credit in more than one strand of the cccri but they are only counted once in the numerator of the calculation so a student could be a cte finisher with their credential and they could also have received credit for say an ap course but they still only count

[01:16:01] once in that numerator this indicator has not been officially part of the accreditation system to date. The plan is for the indicator to be introduced for the 2022-23 accreditation year using students in the 20 that are their four-year cohort is 2021-22. However as Jen mentioned previously for other indicators as practice we have been providing some data to schools about what their indicator would look like if it were part of the accreditation system. Next slide please.

[01:16:39] so i'm sorry maybe can we stay there for a sec so just to clarify it is it is in effect now in the sense that the students who are now i guess who just finished their sophomore year are the class for whom this indicator will be counted in the accreditation system so yes that is true so there are students in high school that will eventually be part of this indicator calculation when it does become part of the accreditation high schools are already or should already be focused on

[01:17:14] on this measure because it's essentially already in effect but we just don't have results until um you know four it takes four years to get results basically yeah that's exactly right so they have been focused on it and they're because we didn't apply it retroactively you know when to students that they hadn't had four four years to get to the measure on so yeah okay that's correct that's a very good point thank you next slide okay sorry i must have i skipped ahead

[01:17:53] i think i covered all those points next slide okay so this should look this is familiar slide to you again um so if we consider a similar 10 students let's say six have been completed the advanced coursework one was a cte finisher with a credential and one achieved the work-based learning experience um we would add those up and they would be eight out of ten which would give them a college and career readiness a cccri of 80 now please note there might be a student who received advanced

[01:18:25] coursework and also work-based learning experience but the rate would not change because they are only counted once in the numerator okay next slide all right so when this indicator does become part accreditation it will again only apply to schools with a graduating class these are the benchmarks notice there is not currently an improvement measure for schools to reach to to move to a higher level. I believe there was none cited because this was a new indicator.

[01:19:02] We were still working on collecting the data to see what's appropriate. So the decision, it's hard to make decision on data. You can't see to determine what an appropriate improvement would be. So this indicator does not currently have an improvement measure. But the four-year consecutive rule will be implemented at the point that it is in the accreditation for that long so um i believe i calculated it's around the accreditation year 26 27 which is a bit away

[01:19:36] that that the four-year consecutive year provision will come into play for these schools okay we'll pause for questions on the school quality indicators and then we'll talk about how accreditation is

ultimately um determined wow this is a lot i really appreciate the very overview of the system and its complexity in an effort to truly try and um you know focus on a number of

[01:20:11] dimensions i as i was listening and thinking about just the process you were using just to create your cut scores or where you were setting your benchmarks i was trying to imagine if there was a by using a standard deviation i know you're using data that the school has to set those but i was curious just to appreciate kind of what is their consistency in the kind of methodology you're using to get at the actual benchmarks that are being used and where you sort of denote your improvement percentages just i mean i know there are different measures for these things but i was

[01:20:51] just curious listening to the very variation and what was presented yeah that's a great question I'll take that. During the process of looking at the data for these indicators, and I would say for most indicators except for the college and career and civic readiness indicator, we had quite a bit of historical data available to us. So we were typically looking at sort of the mean.

[01:21:19] We did look at standard deviations. We did look at the distribution of the values for schools across the state ultimately we didn't settle on one particular method for sort of slicing the data we did run several different models chronic absenteeism i think is one indicator in particular that had a lot of sort of federal and national push for various sort of cut points and so we adopted those to the most extent but really it was more of an iterative process of just sort of

[01:21:54] figuring out where we thought um schools were in terms of kind of average performance on these indicators and where we thought we'd like to see them move in the next couple of years thank you any other questions okay now that we have kind of a broad overview of each performance level um how is accreditation ultimately determined um dr piver and i mentioned the beginning of

[01:22:34] the presentation this model is based on a performance matrix so a school is accredited when all their indicators have either a level one or level two performance level. A school is considered accredited with conditions if any indicator has a level three performance level. And a school could have a status of accreditation denied if the school fails to adopt and implement creative action plans with fidelity. So those are the three ratings that are currently in our system. And I believe at the moment we do not have any accreditation

[01:23:13] denied schools next slide so this is an example of an accredited school this is south middle school notice all their indicators are level one under level two therefore they are accredited in the current system and the next slide shows north high school where go ahead next slide all indicators are level one or level two with the exception of graduation completion index which they earned a level three therefore they are accredited with conditions therefore there's obviously a need

[01:23:50] within the school to take a closer look at truly three indicators the achievement gap in english the graduation completion index and the college career and civic readiness index okay and that is our final slide kind of wraps it all up in the in the final accreditation rating so i'll pause for any additional questions i know this was a lot so you all have been real real patient uh i i do this is dr peckson i do have i do have two questions one um i'm assuming just

[01:24:27] looking at how this is laid out that there was was there any consideration given to give it giving given to giving any priority level to how these are even or maybe not priority waiting um scale to any of these criterias or is it is it just they're all equal meaning meaning achievement doesn't weigh any more

than graduation and school progress and i think that's where the matrix model the beauty of the matrix model comes in um rather than rolling up to a final score which would

[01:25:03] introduce opportunity for weighted um indicators so i'll defer to jen on that yeah i i think you're right julie it is it is kind of the the rationale behind why we went with a matrix model to to not have that weighting uh but i will say that that obviously wasn't a light decision for the board there was a lot of discussion about um you know essentially what we've set up here is a system where you know as julie indicated in in just the last couple of slides you can have one indicator that that is level three and you are accredited with conditions and so uh you know the board did

[01:25:38] go through the process of thinking through uh and and making sure that they were comfortable with the message that they're sending which is that all these indicators are are equivalent um in terms of whether or not the school should be accredited so uh can i can i just weigh in on one thing on uh so backing up to the next to last slide the the final accreditation rating slide

[01:26:08] uh no i'm sorry one more i mean no one more yes thank you one of the fundamental changes we made is that you cannot get to accreditation denied unless you not only have scores that have knocked you off the the levels but also have failed to adopt an improvement plan or failed to implement it and the board has voted on such and that was one of the one of our our assessments that was

[01:26:44] that the accreditation denied ranking had not served a useful purpose other than punishing and labeling and we meant for it to be a very limited criteria a limited option going forward what we did mean to do was to allocate resources according to schools that and divisions that needed help more and there is some waiting I mean math math and reading achievement are weighted more in the sense that

[01:27:18] frankly the test results on other in other subjects don't really play a factor in the final accreditation model and in so those are weighted more but essentially it's a system where you can fall off of a level based on any of the many there are basically many ways to fail the only way to be totally successful is to have all of your indicators in level one or two if that makes sense. And Jen and team, feel free to correct me if I'm wrong. While listening to this,

[01:27:55] I'm like, oh my gosh, there's lots of things we were trying to do and some of which we accomplished and some of which we didn't. And as I say, complexity, simplicity was not something we set out to accomplish and definitely not something we did accomplish. So, you know, to the extent that this group understands this, we and the superintendents may be the only ones who actually understand it and and uh even for us and and uh do we staff and even for us it's a little bit through the through a glass darkly this is shelley i think while the indicators are not

[01:28:33] weighted when you think about what is in the indicators achievement does have a greater weight because we have achievement in english math and science and then addition we look at achievement gaps for reading and math and the board's deliberation about including the achievement gaps in reading and math was very deliberate to ensure that we were shedding a light on student groups where additional assistance was needed.

[01:29:08] So I guess as I was thinking about the indicators, while we don't weight any of them separately, we do have more that deal with achievement just by the nature of what we include.

[01:29:26] I have a another question or really more of a thought about whether this was a thought or consideration at the time. So in the vein of continuous improvement and driving that, driving that

outcome of continuous improvement, if a school is at level two for everything, you know, so they're still accredited, right, they don't have any conditions because they don't have a level three

[01:29:58] indicator so if they're at level two was there any consideration around what's their motivation to get better to drive improvement meaning if you're at a level two for five years at some point when do you get a little kick in the chops to you know be motivated to do more yeah you do um that's the four consecutive years at level two or level three so um after after that length of time if you haven't figured out how to get yourself to level one yes indeed that

[01:30:36] your rating will become a level three after four years and that was another situation where the board did have extensive discussions um board members did not want schools who were continuing to struggle and not improving to not receive additional support so julie is correct that's that's why that that was put into place this is diane i'm trying to raise my hand and i don't know how to let somebody know but there's another piece to this is that we have a continuous improvement

[01:31:11] model and so even for those divisions or schools that are accredited and even those are credited with conditions the expectation is that they're doing their own improvement plans looking at what where they are and how to improve and that's language that's in the standards of accreditation but doesn't is it reflected in the ratings yeah if i may follow up on that one of the you did hear back at the beginning one of the principles this was this whole approach was

[01:31:49] premised on was targeting our resources towards those who most needed it the divisions that most needed it and and that there was an underlying equity concept to that even if not articulated but that in if if this works as we intended the schools that were required to be more engaged with the department of education and to get the benefit of the department of education oversight and collaboration are the ones who most need improvement and we also intended to target we

[01:32:25] actually looked at you know calculations how many schools would end up how many divisions would end up in accredited with conditions and in requiring improvement plans of various sorts to say was it going to be a manageable number because if you know basically half of our schools are required to be in an intense oversight with the department of education but we don't have the resources to make that a reality then it doesn't it's kind of meaningless so that was one of our goals and and so one of my questions globally is um i i missed the very beginning of the meeting i was

[01:33:03] having trouble logging in so forgive me if you all already discussed this but what's the what what are we trying to achieve by now looking at the standards of accreditation and one of my question would be within that what do we know about how it's working and I know it's very early especially with the fact that we didn't have achievement tests this year so what would have been our first real full year of full implementation has coronavirus took it off the charts and yet there may well be ways we can have some sense of how is this working what have been problems

[01:33:41] what measures are not for instance achievement gap measures are are too many schools ending up with ends that are so big that you're not getting any data or you know so how how is it working what's working what's not and um is now what what are we looking to achieve by by opening this now i i can see lots of things that i wish we had done differently but i'm also like wait a minute we We have barely had any experience under this new model.

[01:34:13] So I'm not sure what we're doing. We're taking a new look now. So forgive me since I missed the beginning of the conversation. - Well, you want me to do this one, Keisha? - Have at it.

[01:34:28] - No, you're welcome to, you're chairing this. But I guess since this was started, that is a fundamental question. There's no doubt about that. And the goal was not to just revisit accreditation system entirely that is we've just been through years of that and certainly when we started down this path all of us expected to begin to have some data you know the interruption by the closing of schools and pandemic and

[01:35:05] frankly the uncertainty with regard to what form schools will look you know will take as we open up in the fall has certainly changed the complexion of where we are. However, at the same time, as you noted before, there are certain things that we did seek to achieve by this, and it may not be too early to see if some of those things are coming to fruition. You know, we now have at least one sitting superintendent

[01:35:35] on our board and on this committee, and it would be interesting to know, honestly, whether the levers in the standards of accreditation are actually driving behavioral change at the district level. And, you know, as we get more and more complex, you know, one of the questions that continues to arise is, is it so complex right now that behaviors are not changing in the directions we want because the guidance isn't really clear enough? You know, we're coming out of that period

[01:36:15] where the accreditation was really, or the system, was really just a measure of performance, right? The thought then was, we'll measure performance, we'll provide resources to those places that aren't performing well, and everybody will do better. Well, we didn't really see that happen, and so we made significant changes. But through all of this, the underlying assumption is that the accreditation system, much like the SOQs, will in fact end up driving behavior at the

[01:36:46] the district level, at the division level. I don't think it's too early to begin to look at what behaviors have been occurring at the division level to see if we are in fact moving the ball in the right direction. And if it is just so, you know, if what we want them to do is so obscured through things like the composite index, for an example, are there ways where we can make changes where we more directly identify and push in appropriate directions.

[01:37:23] Now, we've done certain really good things here, right? I mean, we have certainly taken away in part the precision of measurement that the old system had and therefore some of the enticement to shift from jurisdiction to jurisdiction, although we'll see whether test scores still drive that.

[01:37:41] But you may be, and I know you didn't say this, but one of the underlying assumptions is you may be right. may be a little early uh i don't think it would have been too early had we gone through the round of testing and had a normal year and honestly you know when i thought about doing this still and asking keisha to run this you know the thought was you know is it now given where we are too early i don't think so i think we can still it may take a slightly different form than i thought it would in terms of asking people like Dr. Durand and others who run larger jurisdictions, you know,

[01:38:21] and poorer jurisdictions frankly, have these standards changed your resource allocation? And if not, why not? I mean, you know, and how are you going to meet, if you will, our goal, which is really to maximize the potential of each of our children, however we want to say that. And so I mean unless the

committee believes that this is premature and if they do that's fine I mean well I certainly don't ever believe in doing work for no reason right there's just no point in that

[01:38:54] for any of us uh but I feel that you know I'll give you an example you know we had a conversation actually when we were first coming out with these things because measure for uh chronic absenteeism and I happened to be at a public hearing on a different topic talking to a superintendent who will remain nameless and you know first comment from him was we can't possibly do this we can't be responsible for our kids being in school you know that's not our job that's the parents job

[01:39:28] and you know the board though felt and you know every study we've seen says you can't educate them unless they're in school and frankly 10 percent is still an awful lot of school to miss And you hear it down in Southwest too, when I was there, geez.

[01:39:46] But they have found ways to entice kids into school. So there's one measure that we put in that I believe if we analyze it, we will see this has been a success and at least short-term success. They found creative ways to bring more kids into school, a positive, whether that will have the next level of result, whether the logic model holds and then we have better outcomes on, tests etc that remains to be seen but we certainly in some places that have seen some evidence that

[01:40:19] we've improved attendance you know i'd like to see whether the other significant policy thrusts that we have put in the system are in fact being addressed in the same way that we've seen things like chronic absenteeism addressed in the field and that to me is really what this is about and like i said you know if it's if we consider the rest of y'all consider this to be not a useful effort and you know there are other things we ought to be doing you know i'm certainly in favor

[01:40:55] of maximizing outcomes uh you know with the resources we have but that's sort of the thought process to how we got where we got you know we did not expect to be exactly where we are today obviously. But like I said, I still think we've got value added to this process.

[01:41:14] Mr. Dett? Dr. Lane speaking. Dr. Lane, go ahead. Francisco, you go ahead first, please. I was going to say thank you, Ann, for those questions. I think it's very important. And Dr. Paxton did at the beginning say that today was really about helping give us a grounding.

[01:41:33] So we all had commonality around what had occurred thus far and making sure we had that common sense of understanding but i do think on the next moving forward i know dr frexton will help us come up with a focus and how we can really do it dances and i don't think it's too early i think it's important to do it at this stage because as we think of any major change that we're asking school systems to do and i think we do need to pause and understand what are the implications early on yes there are some to your point that we wouldn't be able to assess at this point without some additional data and some more longevity of review but i think at this point it

[01:42:10] is important to pause and see what are the implications and i won't repeat a lot of what dan said i agree with much of what he said and i hope that we will continue to do this and i hope we will do it in a way as dr pexton and i talked um on the phone about it to really begin to frame and shape uh understanding of what's occurred any potentials as dr pexton said at the onset we're not going in here saying we need to change everything we're going here to say to understand and assess what have been the implications of this part and do there need to be any potential adjustments or not but that the point is not

to come in here and say well let's come in and change everything it's too soon for that i would say but i don't think it's not too soon to understand where

[01:42:49] we can address some potential areas so i also want to say um mr president having miss davis bought on the board is also very important because having the voice of what occurs at the principal level and school level is critical and what i think we can find and unpack yeah i was just i was just curious more about you know i thought we set some money aside so on i don't want to wait too long i'm not sure that is more i think we need to get that ball rolling as well so we're not you know so we may have have we run over our allotted time and is that i believe we

[01:43:23] have we well i think this is um this is the board's account so i'm not sure uh we're the only ones going i'll uh i'll jump in now it sounds like that person realized they were unmuted but uh uh francisco did you finish yes thank you uh the only other piece that that i would add is um in terms of the value of this exercise now is now that school divisions have actually gotten to

[01:43:57] experience the accreditation system there are nuances of it that i think that they would want to uh they would want to recommend to you some changes the other thing that i would say is now Now that we're a couple of years further into the board's profile, Emily, I think that might be that phone number that ends, and I know what number.

[01:44:27] I have muted the number. I'm not sure where it's coming from. Okay. Well, that's all right. As the school divisions have moved further along their work in the profile of Virginia But I would say that they would also say that there are indicators that drive that work that may not be ported by such a deep focus on achievement only.

[01:44:55] And I think even in a recent letter, we held the accreditation task force to talk about accreditation during COVID. But a side grouping of the folks that were a part of that did not include Ms. Atkinson because she asked to be recused from that, sent a letter to us that talked about how we can overemphasize some new indicators to promote some of the board's other work.

[01:45:22] And then I would say the last piece of it is, even though we've spent a great deal of time on how schools are accredited, there are other components in the SOA that I think are worthy of a second look just to make sure that we help our, we help our school divisions move forward on the board's goals. So those would be three other things I would add, but completely agree with Francisco and Dan as well. So if I may just chime in, I'm convinced. I think you all laid it out well and it makes sense to go forward and I'll just add one more thing, which is

[01:45:57] as we know from the last round, it can take a long time to make changes. So if there are further changes that need to be made or that come out of this committee. It may be some time and we may have more data to help guide the change process as it goes along. The one thing I would say, well, one further thing I would say in support of taking a look now is just the sheer complexity of the system. As I've emphasized before, even the superintendents and we may not have fully understood it when we implemented it. So now that they've had a little bit of experience,

[01:46:34] chance, they may be able to come back and help us tweak some things, that at least, whether or not they simplify it, at least help clarify it, and so I'm all for it. I would just urge caution in that recognizing that we really don't yet know whether this met the original goals, and it certainly wouldn't be

likely helpful to the divisions to make drastic changes before they've had a chance to uh uh aim for for the the goals that this uh these

[01:47:09] changes sent them off pursuing unless there was a very very strong reason to do so so uh with that with that caution i'm all on board thank you for clarifying for me uh this is dr pexton i i would just like to add one additional thought to that um co-signing on everything that was just said but um to the point that that that um miss holton made about change takes a long time to occur that is that is that is absolutely true except in the case when you're forced to abruptly because i think

[01:47:49] we would all agree that the last six months quite a bit has changed um quite quickly on on grand scales in a lot of cases and so uh i think it's yes for you know change can occur will occur in the long term but it actually in actuality it has occurred quite a bit in the short term so i do think the lens in which this criteria was set up around a year ago two years ago three years ago that lens has shifted just a little bit um even in the last um i'm sorry did i cut out um even in the last

[01:48:25] three or four months so i think part of this committee's review is again not to go in with the intention of changing a whole lot or changing anything but validating that where we are today and where we're going and the progress or the behaviors, the progress that we're already seeing, just kind of really cinching that up and making sure that what was intended is occurring and if there's any changes that need to happen because of what's changed, then we can consider it.

[01:49:14] Okay, I figured it out now. so will the committee develop a schedule for coming back to report uh to the board um as the work gets underway yes uh so we meet tomorrow just to kind of as a as a organizing team talk about logistics um you know at that point we'll talk a little bit about what a reasonable timeline looks like based on how often we're going to meet um and so um uh you know i don't want to speak for

[01:49:48] that committee yet but yes the answer is yes we will be wanting to come back in iterations to kind of catch the board up on what we've learned what we're observing and hearing and to and to then get some feedback at that point so yes great so there'll be an opportunity for some back and forth as the work is going versus something coming at the end and that's awesome great thank you yes and then

[01:50:15] And also, while the committee will be meeting, board members are welcome to attend those meetings as they choose, if they want to just kind of lean in and they don't want to wait for a board meeting to get an update. So be able to take advantage of both options.

[01:50:33] Yeah, when I'm sending out the schedules, you know, we'll certainly alert all board members to when the special committee meets. But those you know that would not be a requirement, except for those that are specifically on the committee. Great. All right, if that was the presentation. I'm sorry. Okay, I'm getting a lot of feedback. If that wraps up the presentation from the department, and that's all that was to share.

[01:51:10] I guess we'll just open it up for any final comments or thoughts from the board i've taken a lot of good notes here just on some of the. feedback from the board members experiences themselves, as well as some of the questions that the board is asked and will be.

[01:51:26] For the committee will review some of that and i'd like you to bring your notes as well tomorrow's kind of what you captured from this discussion, but specifically to the board. is there any specific um whether it's an indicator or any data point that you've heard about today that you would like to

make sure that this committee digs a little deeper into dr pexton i if i if i'm allowed to throw one out i have one okay the uh i would like to look uh take a second

[01:52:03] look at the way that we decided to measure growth i like the combined rate but i don't know that we're actually measuring growth and then um so that's that's one area that i i know i would love love to have conversation about. And I'd love to time you all have probably all heard me say that we our growth measure does not apply to third grade yet because we haven't figured out how to essentially though we were and we're working on it so growth rate for third grade and then just generally thinking

[01:52:39] about the the equity work we've been doing what's missing in this that even if we can't in the short term we may in the long term want to add in i don't see anything about teacher quality and there's reasons why we don't feel like we had there's the teacher and i think we did look at teacher retention measures whether there were possibilities for how to how to get at that but the result was we didn't add anything in

[01:53:14] um this is diane just i sat on that task force that dr um lane mentioned and just thinking about how unsettled we are and where we're going forward i think it may be worth the committees uh to look at chronic absenteeism in light of what might occur in in the future and how that might impact schools and then the other piece is the college career readiness index and school's

[01:53:48] ability to provide those opportunities for students in in our future within the next year or so because you think about that cohort there's they're losing time to create those opportunities so just just thinking about that as far as um accreditation going forward this isn't

[01:54:11] No, that's okay. This isn't related to an indicator per se, but as we were going through the presentation, I was thinking about the whole resource issue and just what it takes to actually facilitate growth and movement.

[01:54:28] And I don't know that we have enough information to begin to understand that, but I am curious about how we know where resources are being devoted to push improvement and change given the work we did with the SOQ and the funding that's required I mean I was that the slide that talked about SOQ being an important part of the conceptual frame of this new system I just I do wonder about the the question of as we push for improvement how do we understand the

[01:55:06] resources it takes to make progress and we may not have enough data at this point with this system to understand that, and it's not related to indicator, but I do wonder about the reality of that element. And along the lines of Dr. Lane, what he said earlier about growth, I am concerned, it won't be surprised many of you, about understanding the implications with our English language learners and the intent behind what was put in place with regards to not only the academic growth, but also things like attendance and high school graduation and dropout. I would like us

[01:55:45] to understand the implications of what did it turn out in terms of what we were attempting to do in capturing the fact that schools are supporting that population and did our accreditation measures actually capture that and is there any way to honor the work that they're doing and the support that they are doing for students perhaps in a different way? Dr. Pexton, what I was going to add is there are two indicators that did not make the cut for the board in 2017 that I think are worth revisiting one is student discipline because of the disproportionate rates of suspensions

[01:56:23] especially for black students is that an indicator that we may want to drive more equity in and then the other one for me you looked at school climate and we were developing some tools there we've now done some combination work with the school climate survey it's done through DCJS and that both of these indicators might bring great concern to school districts but I think the board should uh revisit and discuss each of those as potential opportunities to improve the accreditation system dr lean can you remind me too isn't there some new measure that the feds

[01:57:00] required us to have about uh teacher is it teacher pay equity what between schools or how much exactly yeah so it actually goes live in the next two weeks uh but there's a there's an essa per pupil expenditure report which essentially will show the per pupil expenditure no longer at the division level but at the school level and what you mentioned teacher pay some of the concern that you may find in that data if this ends up being true we'll see what comes out is that you'll find that maybe wealthier schools on average have more experienced teachers which will mean that

[01:57:39] they'll be inherently higher per pupil per school because typically schools pay based on experience and so certainly that's an indicator that's probably worthy of the board's review as as you as as you have through the soq process thought about diversifying the teacher pool uh that's that indicator will certainly uh have a lot of information for you to look at so it's not a pay teacher pay measure but it is a per pupil expenditure measure that is largely influenced by teacher seniority at least and and maybe teacher quality measures

[01:58:16] yes gotcha i would i would really the board the committee to look at that and and all of these look at everything in light of our equity principles that that we have identified as part of our strategic plan and our focus and that that notion of of of pay is my hypothesis we'll have to see when the data actually comes out but uh but that that that information about the amount that's spent per pupil per school goes live in the next two weeks okay all all really

[01:58:56] good feedback. I think I've captured a pretty good representation of that to have a committee consider. Any other thoughts or questions? Thank you for saying yes. Yes. Thank you for saying yes times times three or times four because I'm thankful for Francisco, Pam, and Jamel. Dr. Pexton, I have one more. I'm sorry. You and I haven't had a chance to to discuss this topic, so I know this is the only time.

[01:59:32] Might we ask staff, and I'll be happy to do this on your behalf, but might we ask staff to look at if there are other indicators in other states that we're not using that other states have adopted so that we can see how other states are measuring academic progress or, you know, school accountability?

[01:59:50] I know a little bit about that to know there are some other indicators, but I just think that'll be really interesting for the board. Yes, we'll capture that. That's something that I was interested in understanding myself. Keisha Nzewi: Any other thoughts or questions. Sorry, I have a six year old arriving home and he's getting the dog all riled up.

[02:00:20] Keisha Nzewi: God bless you. Keisha Nzewi: Okay, so like I mentioned before Emily, if you can help me out. Remind me what time the meeting is tomorrow for the committee. I don't have my agenda in front of me. Yes, absolutely. So the regular business meeting for the full board is tomorrow at 10 and then the organizational meeting for committee members is at one o'clock.

[02:00:48] So we anticipate there'll be about an hour break in between. That way, folks can grab a bite to eat and, you know, check email and whatever else you need to do before we reconvene at one. Okay, great.

Thank you. All right, well, that will conclude this portion of the committee review of the accreditation session. So unless there's any other thoughts from the board, I'll turn things back over to Dan.

[02:01:19] Your meeting. So I guess we're done. I know that's one thing I know how to do is end the meeting. I just wanted to be respectful of make sure you didn't have any closing thoughts. appreciate all the work that's going to happen here. I certainly appreciate you agreeing to do it and the experience on the committee can't be topped. So that's all great.

[02:01:40] Thanks so much and we'll see you guys tomorrow at 10. Bye. Thanks.

